

Janthari Help & FAQ Feedback Draft

Getting Started

Q1. Why is birth time so important?

A. Birth time (to the minute) determines your Lagna (ascendant), which is the foundation of your entire birth chart. A 1-minute difference can change your Lagna, shifting all planetary placements and predictions. This is why accurate birth time is critical.

Q2. Should I generate a birth chart for my newborn?

A. It's helpful for reference and understanding your child's personality tendencies. Many families do this to find auspicious timings for naming ceremonies, first haircut, etc. Start their Janam Din Puja tradition on their first birthday.

Q3. If birth is around midnight, which date should I enter?

A. Use official hospital-record date and clock time as primary input. Births around 11:50 PM to 12:10 AM are very sensitive because date rollover can change houses and sometimes key boundaries. If family memory says a different traditional date, keep that as a note, but compute chart on documented civil date/time first. Practical rule: for midnight cases, double-check AM/PM and timezone before interpreting results.

Q4. How do timezone and daylight saving affect calculations?

A. A lot. Birth time must be interpreted in the local timezone at that historical date, including daylight saving where applicable. If timezone is off by even 1 hour, Lagna and house placements can shift. Practical rule: for births outside India, verify city and date-specific timezone first before trusting interpretation.

Q5. Can Janthari be used offline at home during rituals?

A. Most core help content and previously saved data can be used offline. Some dynamic calculations or sync flows may need internet depending on feature path. Practical rule: open and verify required screens before starting ritual if connectivity is uncertain.

Q6. Is there an Android or App Store app? What is the future plan?

A. Right now Janthari is available on web. Roadmap plan: Phase 1 native Android app, Phase 2 native iOS app, Phase 3 assistant integrations (Siri shortcuts and Alexa-style voice support), and Phase 4 deeper personalization and reminders. We will publish rollout updates openly as each phase is ready.

Q7. How can I bookmark the website so it is easy to access?

A. Use these quick steps: iPhone Safari -> Share -> Add to Home Screen. Android Chrome -> Menu -> Add to Home Screen. Desktop -> click the Star icon in browser and pin the tab if needed. This makes Janthari open like an app shortcut.

Calendar

Q1. Why is the lunar calendar different from the regular calendar?

A. The lunar calendar is based on the Moon's 29.5-day cycle, while the solar calendar is based on Earth's 365-day orbit around the Sun. Hindu festivals are timed to lunar dates because ancient traditions observed the Moon's spiritual significance.

Q2. How exactly is Tithi calculated in Janthari?

A. Short answer: we calculate it from Moon-Sun angle, not from calendar date alone. Formula used is $\text{Tithi number} = \text{floor}(((\text{Moon longitude} - \text{Sun longitude}) \bmod 360) / 12) + 1$. Each Tithi is a 12 degree slice. Since Moon speed is not constant, Tithi duration is not fixed at 24 hours. So yes, one Tithi can end in the middle of

your day. Practical KP-family rule: always trust the exact start/end time window, not just the Tithi name for that date.

Q3. Which birthday should we follow: solar date or Janma Tithi?

A. Both are valid, but they serve different purposes. Solar birthday is civil/social (school, office, legal records). Janma Tithi is traditional/spiritual (puja, sankalp, blessings). Practical family rule: celebrate socially on solar date, do puja on Janma Tithi when possible.

Q4. How can we be sure these dates are correct?

A. We use consistent astronomical calculations for Sun-Moon positions and then derive Tithi and lunar month from those values. Still, edge cases near sunrise can look different across apps if settings differ. Simple rule for users: if a date feels unusual, share date + location + screenshot with us and we will verify quickly.

Q5. Why does a Tithi sometimes appear to be "missing" on the calendar?

A. Great question. In Kashmiri Pandit and other Hindu calendars, sometimes a lunar day (Tithi) is so short that it doesn't "prevail" (reach sunrise) at all. This is called a Kshaya Tithi (skipped day). When this happens, you'll see a note on the calendar like "Pratipada was short (kshaya tithi) — missing day." This explains the jump and is not an error. Example: In June 2026, Amavasya is followed by Pratipada the next day, but Pratipada was very short, so the calendar skips from Amavasya directly to Dwitiya. Practical family rule: When you see a "missing day" note, it means the lunar calendar shows the astronomical reality—that Tithi was too short to observe at your sunrise. These are common in Kashmiri calendars.

Q6. Why does a Tithi sometimes appear on two consecutive days?

A. Sometimes a lunar day (Tithi) is long enough to span two calendar days. This is called an Adhika Tithi (double day). When this happens, you'll see a note like "Double day — Ashtami appears on two consecutive days." This is also normal and reflects the Moon's actual position. The two-day Tithi does not duplicate festivals or pujas; you celebrate on the first occurrence or check with your priest. Practical rule: if your Janma Tithi (birth Tithi) appears twice in a year, celebrate on the first occurrence, unless your family tradition says otherwise.

Q7. I see "Amavasya" is now shown correctly with a note about missing day. What changed?

A. We updated Janthari to show true lunar dates and add helpful flags when Tithis are missing or doubled. Previously, when a Tithi was very short, the calendar would replace it with the next one for continuity. Now we show the actual observed Tithi and add a note explaining what happened. This is more transparent and helps families understand the lunar calendar better. For example: June 15, 2026 now correctly shows Amavasya (Mavas) with a note that Pratipada was short. This update applies to all dates and calendars going forward.

Tekni

Q1. How accurate is my Tekni if I only know my birth date, not time?

A. Very limited. Without birth time, you can't determine your Lagna (the most important factor). You'd be missing house placements and accurate predictions. Use noon as an estimate if needed, but finding your actual birth certificate is strongly recommended.

Q2. Why does changing location change my chart and Muhurat?

A. Because astrology is sky-at-location based, not generic-country based. Location changes timezone and local horizon. Lagna depends on the rising sign at that exact place/time, so nearby cities can still shift house boundaries. Muhurat can also move because sunrise-linked and local-time calculations depend on latitude/longitude. Practical rule: enter exact birth city first; if unknown, use nearest real town and keep that choice consistent everywhere.

Q3. If my birth time is approximate, how much should I trust the result?

A. Use confidence bands: +/- 5 minutes is usually usable, +/- 15 minutes is moderate, and +/- 30+ minutes is low confidence for house-level readings. Moon-sign tendencies can still be directionally useful, but Lagna and houses may shift. Practical family rule: if time uncertainty is big, use the chart for broad guidance only, and avoid final marriage/career timing decisions until birth time is confirmed or rectified.

Q4. Why did my Nakshatra change after correcting time/location?

A. Nakshatra boundaries are degree-based, so small input fixes can move the Moon across a boundary. Correcting birth minute, city coordinates, or timezone can therefore change Nakshatra and related outputs like Nadi/Yoni. Practical rule: finalize inputs first, then freeze chart for family use.

Q5. Do we need to regenerate Tekni every year?

A. Birth chart (Tekni) itself is fixed for life once correct inputs are set. What changes over time are transits and timing interpretations. Practical rule: keep one verified Tekni, then refresh forecasts/Muhurat checks when planning events.

Muhurat

Q1. Is Muhurat mandatory, or can I start an event anytime?

A. You can start anytime, but choosing an auspicious Muhurat is believed to increase chances of success by aligning with favorable planetary positions. Think of it as choosing a day when "luck is on your side." Many families follow Muhurat tradition, others don't—it's a personal choice.

Q2. How does Janthari decide a Muhurat is good or bad?

A. It is a combined decision, not a one-line yes/no. Janthari checks Vara (weekday ruler), event-fit of Tithi, Nakshatra quality, and exclusion windows (for example eclipse periods), then ranks windows as high/medium/avoid. In plain family language: first we remove clearly bad slots, then we rank the remaining slots. Practical rule: if you cannot take the top slot, pick the next green window for the same event type instead of randomizing by convenience.

Q3. If two Muhurat windows are good, how should we pick one?

A. Pick by this order: (1) higher rank in app, (2) better practical readiness (all key people available), (3) calmer window with fewer logistical risks. In family practice, a "good and executable" Muhurat is better than a "perfect but chaotic" one.

Puja

Q1. Do I need to be religious to perform puja?

A. No. Puja is a ritual that works for anyone—it's about intention, gratitude, and creating sacred space. You don't need to believe in deities; you can use puja as a mindfulness practice or intention-setting ceremony.

Q2. If we do not have full Samagri, can we still do puja properly?

A. Yes. Minimum valid setup is clean space, diya (or safe lamp), water, and sincere sankalp. Flowers/incense/sweets improve the ritual but are not mandatory for devotion. Practical family rule: do simple puja correctly rather than postponing endlessly for perfect materials.

FAQ

Q1. Do gemstones really work?

A. Gemstones have been used for centuries in Vedic tradition. Some people report benefits; others don't. If you're interested, consult a reputable gemologist and astrologer. Authenticity is key—fake gemstones won't help. View it as a complementary practice, not a guarantee.

Q2. Why does Janthari sometimes differ from a priest or another Panchang app?

A. This is normal and usually comes from setup differences, not "wrong astrology." Top 4 reasons are: (1) different Ayanamsa setting, (2) timezone/daylight-saving handling, (3) location coordinates used, and (4) rule priority while filtering Muhurat. Even a 1-2 minute shift can cross a boundary. Practical rule for families: compare only after confirming both systems use the same location, timezone, and Ayanamsa. Janthari keeps one consistent KP-oriented path so your results stay stable across repeated checks.

Q3. Should we follow the priest or the app when there is a difference?

A. Use Janthari for transparent baseline and consistency. Then discuss any mismatch with your family priest by comparing assumptions: Ayanamsa, location, timezone, and event rules. Practical rule: align inputs first, then decide together. App and priest should support each other, not compete.

Q4. How do we choose remedies when many are suggested?

A. Prioritize low-risk, repeatable remedies first: daily discipline, mantra, charity, and simple puja. Add gemstones or costly actions only after expert validation. Practical rule: consistent small remedies over 90 days are usually better than expensive one-time fixes.

Q5. What is the underlying data source for this information?

A. Janthari uses rule-based calendar logic plus astronomical formulas (Sun and Moon positions) implemented in the app code. Festival mappings are curated in our Kashmiri Pandit festival dataset and monthly observance rules. We do not randomly copy one external panchang feed; we apply one consistent method so results remain stable.

Q6. I wish to do voluntary contribution. How can I help?

A. You can help in practical ways: report date issues, suggest missing KP observances, review language for elders, and help test new features before release. A dedicated contribution/support section is being planned, and once ready we will publish clear options for volunteer and financial support.

Q7. How can I provide feedback to improve the website?

A. You can currently share feedback through our existing contact/support channel. We are adding a dedicated "Feedback" section inside Help so users can submit ideas directly from the app/website. For best action, share: what you expected, what happened, screenshot, date, and location.